

1 Grading Criteria for the Project Report

Project Setup & Research Design (20%)

- Are the research questions clearly defined, coherent, and well-motivated?
- Is the replication goal articulated, and is the extension logically derived from the original study?
- Are the dataset and variables appropriately chosen and justified?
- Is the preprocessing thorough and suitable for the econometric analysis?

Code Quality & Reproducibility (20%)

- Does the code run correctly and reproduce the original study's results?
- Is the code well-structured, documented, and easy to follow?
- Does it follow good coding practices (e.g., clarity, efficiency, modularization)?
- Is the extension properly implemented in the code, and does it integrate well with the replication?

Econometric Methods & Implementation (25%)

- Are the applied econometric techniques appropriate for the research question?
- Are the methods correctly implemented, with careful consideration of assumptions and potential biases?
- Are robustness checks performed and adequately discussed?
- Are any limitations in the methodology acknowledged and addressed?

Interpretation of Results & Critical Discussion (20%)

- Are the results correctly interpreted, and do they answer the research questions?
- Is the comparison between replication and extension meaningful and well-explained?
- Are potential weaknesses or sources of uncertainty discussed?
- Does the analysis provide insightful economic or policy implications?

Report (15%)

- Is the report well-structured, clear, and logically organized?
- Are the findings effectively communicated with appropriate tables, figures, and references?
- Is the writing style precise and adheres to academic standards (e.g., citations, formatting, coherence)?
- Does the report demonstrate a deep understanding of the replicated study and its contribution to the literature?

2 Grading Criteria for the Presentation

Research Design & Project Objectives (25%)

- Are the research questions and objectives clearly stated and easy to understand?
- Is the motivation for replicating the study well-articulated?
- Is the rationale behind the chosen extension explained and justified?
- Are the key findings from both the replication and the extension presented clearly and concisely?
- Are appropriate visual aids (e.g., tables, graphs, regression outputs) used effectively to support the analysis?

Methodological Challenges & Solutions (40%)

- Are the main methodological challenges (e.g., data limitations, econometric assumptions, model selection) clearly identified?
- Are the solutions to these challenges well-justified, with a strong focus on econometric reasoning and implementation?
- Is there a critical reflection on the strengths and weaknesses of the applied methods?
- Are robustness checks, alternative specifications, or sensitivity analyses discussed when relevant?
- Are potential limitations and remaining challenges acknowledged in a thoughtful manner?

Communication & Clarity (20%)

- Is the presentation well-structured, logical, and easy to follow?
- Are complex econometric concepts explained in an accessible yet rigorous way?
- Are the slides visually clear, well-organized, and free of unnecessary clutter?
- Do presenters engage with the audience, demonstrating confidence and expertise?

Q&A and Discussion (15%)

- Do presenters provide clear, well-reasoned responses to audience questions?
- Are answers supported by the presented analysis and econometric concepts?
- Do presenters demonstrate a solid understanding of their methods, results, and potential limitations?
- Are they able to engage in a meaningful discussion beyond what was explicitly presented in the slides?